

Dear Hiring Committee,

This search is likely difficult because no single-discipline leader is enough. The role needs someone who can move between process technology, quality, customer commitments, capacity, capital, digital systems, and leadership without losing the thread. That intersection is where I have spent my career.

The pressure behind the search is understandable: growth cannot outrun operational control, standardization cannot erase technical advantage, and productivity cannot come at the expense of safety, quality, delivery, or customer confidence. The leader has to respect what each site knows while creating enough common language and decision discipline for the network to act as one enterprise.

At Compunetics, I progressed through R&D, production, strategic acquisition, operations, and director-level leadership in advanced electronics and high-reliability environments. At Amazon, I led 24/7 launch and execution supporting approximately five million second-day orders annually. At Vape-Jet, I now connect production, quality, purchasing, engineering, customers, support, telemetry, ERP, and AI-assisted workflows in a robotics and machine-vision business.

The recurring pattern is operating integration. I make complex technical work visible, connect the people who hold different pieces of the truth, clarify authority, and install mechanisms that turn signals into decisions and decisions into accountable execution. That is how I would approach global capacity, footprint, capital, make-versus-buy, NPI readiness, operating performance, and leadership development.

My point of view is direct: standardize the operating contract and differentiate the technical capability. The enterprise should share one language for safety, quality, delivery, cost, capacity, capital, escalation, and learning. Sites should retain the process knowledge and judgment that create real customer value.

I built an independent candidate vision for the role at <https://russelldudek.github.io/VPConfidential/>. It includes the Manufacturing Shape Contract, an executive fit brief, a calibrated interview thesis, an executive scorecard, and a first-120-day entry plan. Because the employer is confidential, the work is framed as a discovery hypothesis rather than invented company knowledge.

I would begin with calibrated questions: What must never break as the network grows? Which differences genuinely create customer or technical advantage? Where are local leaders solving enterprise problems without enterprise visibility? What first-year decision would best reveal whether the operating system is ready for the next phase?

What would it look like to put this combination of technical manufacturing, distributed execution, digital operations, and mechanism-building leadership against one of the company's most consequential first-year decisions?

Carpe diem,

Russell Dudek